was booked by the police with heavy politics playing out. Such instances of dirty politicking over the miseries of the people became commonplace. People were angry and no state chief minister wanted to take the blame or accept any wrongdoing on their part.

While some states with decisive leadership managed to course correct pretty quickly, some failed at doing so for extended periods of time. The situation in the national capital had gotten very critical with the city clocking over 20,000 cases in a single day, for several weeks. Of course the health infrastructure of Delhi was so overwhelmed and the Government of National Capital Territory of Delhi was so inept at managing the crisis that the cases spilled over to the bordering states, which too fell to the same fate. Not only hospitals, even crematoriums began to be overwhelmed, with many of them conducting mass funerals. Pictures of these began to go viral all over the national and international media, causing emotional anxiety and distress to the people of the country. Photo journalists captured pictures of people in despair waiting outside hospitals, struggling to breathe. Some journalists like Barkha Dutt took to the road to investigate how mass funerals were taking place in smaller towns and villages and documented images of cremations done by immersing bodies in the Ganga, the holy river of the Hindus.[2] Dutt went so far as to sit on the roads outside crematoriums, hospitals and just about anywhere to demonstrate how she was the only ‘chosen one’ to reveal the Holy Grail. She’d interview men who’d be building pyres for the cremation of the Hindu individual; she’d interview rural folks in hamlets along the Ganga asking them questions about bodies being buried in the sand. She’d put up pictures of meals she’s picking up off the streets during her travels with captions detailing the difficulty of her journey—it all seemed so rehearsed, so strategized. Sadly, she never saw fit to sit outside government offices where bureaucrats were working 24/7 or outside homes of folks who were recovering due to the incessant efforts of our healthcare workers, outside PDS ration shops to see how millions were being distributed food by the government so that they don’t go hungry or even inside Muslim burial grounds for that matter. Did deaths of folks of other religions didn’t warrant coverage? Or was the reward not as chunky as the reward for Hindu pyres? While haters of the establishment enjoyed the graveyard shift show that she put on, many eyes didn’t fail to notice her blatant inclination to sell the emotion of Hindu pyres and deaths. Even when her own father unfortunately succumbed to